

Masonry Veneer and Concrete

How a brick wall that is not holding anything up is built, and the two spacings the exam asks for.

Veneer wall	A wall constructed of both wood frame and masonry. The frame carries the load; the masonry is a skin hung on the outside of it.
Lintel	The beam over an opening in masonry, carrying the masonry above it.
Arch	The curved alternative to a lintel, carrying load by compression around the curve.

A wood framed brick veneer wall is the single wall most likely to contain both a lintel and an arch: it has enough masonry to need one over each opening, and enough decoration to use the other.

The numbers here

Brick veneer ties — horizontal spacing	32 in
Brick veneer ties — vertical spacing	18 in

The ties are what stop the skin falling away from the frame. Thirty-two across, eighteen up — the wider spacing is the horizontal one, because the courses themselves already tie the wall together sideways.

Brick orientation and concrete finishing

Sailor	A brick laid upright with its wide side showing. The exam asks for this one by name.
Bull floating	The finishing pass that brings fine aggregate to the surface of a concrete slab, filling and smoothing it before final finishing.

Say it back

Cover the page. Answer each one out loud.

1. What is a veneer wall, and what carries the load in one?
2. Which single wall is most likely to have both a lintel and an arch?
3. Give the brick tie spacings, horizontal and vertical.
4. What is a sailor?
5. What does bull floating do to a slab?